

International Organizations

Which among the following organization helps world's poorest countries?

The International Development Association (IDA) is the part of the World Bank that helps the world's poorest countries. It complements the World Bank's other lending arm — the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) — which serves middle-income countries with capital investment and advisory services.

- IDA

**The United Nations General Assembly
appoints the Secretary-General of the
United Nations on recommendation of
which of the following organ?**

The Security Council

- The United Nations General Assembly appoints the Secretary-General based on the recommendation of the Security Council, as outlined in Article 97 of the UN Charter. This process emphasizes the Security Council's role in maintaining international peace and security, as the Secretary-General often acts as a mediator in conflicts. The first Secretary-General was Trygve Lie, appointed in 1946.

Which among the following major United Nations site is known as UNO city?

Vienna

- Along with New York, Geneva and Nairobi, Vienna is a major UN site which holds the offices of Comprehensive Nuclear-Test-Ban Treaty Organization (CTBTO), International Atomic Energy Agency, United Nations Commission on International Trade Law, United Nations Industrial Development Organization, United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime, United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees , United Nations Office for Outer Space Affairs. Please note that The VIC (Vienna International center) is an extraterritorial area and is free from local area jurisdiction

Which one of the following was used as a chemical weapon in the First World War?

Mustard gas

- Although the Germans were the first to use phosgene on the battlefield, it became the primary chemical weapon of the Allies. Phosgene was responsible for 85% of chemical-weapons fatalities during World War I. Mustard gas, a potent blistering agent, was dubbed King of the Battle Gases.

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**Which day is celebrated as International
Day of People with Disabilities?**

3 December

Which day is celebrated as World Ozone Day?

16 September

In which city is the headquarters of United Nations (UN) situated ?

New York

When was the UN founded?

The UN officially came into existence in 1945,
with operations beginning on October 24th
of that year.

Who coined the term "United Nations"?

President Franklin D. Roosevelt is credited with coining the term "United Nations".

**How many member states does the UN
currently have?**

The UN currently has 193 member states.

Where is the headquarters of the United Nations located?

The main headquarters of the United Nations
is located in New York, USA.

**How many countries signed the UN Charter
in 1945?**

50 countries signed the UN Charter in 1945.

What are the main areas of the UN's work?

The UN's work covers five main areas:
maintaining international peace and security,
protecting human rights, delivering
humanitarian aid, supporting sustainable
development and climate action, and
upholding international law.

What is the name of the UN body that settles legal disputes between member states?

The International Court of Justice (ICJ) settles legal disputes between member states.

**What are the six principal organs of the
UN?**

The six principal organs are the General Assembly, the Security Council, the Economic and Social Council, the Trusteeship Council, the International Court of Justice, and the UN Secretariat.

**Which UN organ has primary responsibility
for maintaining international peace and
security?**

The Security Council is responsible for maintaining international peace and security.

**How many official languages does the UN
have? .**

The UN has six official languages

- **Arabic, Chinese, English, French, Russian and Spanish.**

What is the United Nations Charter?

A treaty, according to International Law.

**When was the term 'United Nations'
created?**

During World War II.

**Which is the name given to those
countries?**

Original members.

**Name the country which did not sign the
Charter at San Francisco but is still
considered an original member..**

**Poland - which was not able to send a
representative**

**What is the opening statement of the UN
Charter?**

**“We the peoples of the United Nations
determined to save succeeding generations
from the scourge of war.”**

Name the principal Organs of the UN.

**(i) General Assembly; (ii) Security Council;
(iii) International Court of Justice; (iv)
Economic and Social Council; and (v)**

Secretariat

When and how is the General Assembly called in Session?

**The General Assembly's regular session
begins each year on the third Tuesday in
September and continues usually until mid-
December.**

**Are the decisions of the General Assembly
binding on the Governments?**

While the decisions of the GA have no legally binding force for Governments, they carry the weight of world opinion as well as the moral authority of the world community.

How many representatives can each country have in the General Assembly?

Not more than five.

**Does UN Charter provide for the
suspension or expulsion of Member States?**

**Yes, for violation of the principles of the
Charter.**

What is the main function of the Security Council ?

maintenance of International Peace and Security.

Who are the members of the Security Council ?

The Council has 15 members; five permanent members - China, France, The Russian Federation, UK and USA - and 10 elected by the General Assembly for 2 year terms.

What is the 'Veto' power?

The power to Veto any decision by a negative vote in the Security Council.

Who elects non-permanent members of the Security Council?

The UN General Assembly.

**Can the Security Council meet elsewhere
than at its Headquarters in New York and
has it so far met elsewhere?**

**Yes, in 1972 in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia and
in 1973 in Panama City, Panama**

How is the President of the Security Council elected?

**The members take monthly turn in the
presidency in English alphabetical order.**

What and where is the International Court of Justice?

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- The International Court of Justice is the judicial organ of the United Nations. It only deals with cases brought by nations, not individuals. It consists of 15 Judges. The court sits in permanent session at The Hague, Netherlands

**Who appoints the UN Secretary-General
and what is his diplomatic status?**

**The General Assembly appoints on the
recommendation of the Security Council.
He holds the status of a Head of the State.**

What is the tenure of his office?

Five years, but may be re-appointed.

**Who holds the record for delivering the
longest speech at the UN General
Assembly?**

**Mr. V.K Krishna Menon of India, on
January 23, 1957. His speech ran for 7 hours
and 48 minutes over two sessions**

**Which Head of State holds the record for
delivering the longest speech at the UN
General Assembly?**

Fidel Castro delivered the longest speech in the history of the UN General Assembly on September 26, 1960, a 269-minute (4 hour, 29 minute) address.

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**Only one Indian has so far been the
President of the UN General Assembly.
Who is that person ? When and at which
session**

**Mrs. Vijaylakshmi Pandit. At the eight
session in 1953.**

**When and where did the first meeting of
the UN General Assembly take place?**

**On January 10, 1946 in Central Hall,
Westminster, London**

Give the date and venue of the first meeting of the Security Council

**. On January 17, 1946 at Westminster,
London**

Give the date of India's admission to UN

October 30, 1945.

What is the Universal Declaration of Human Rights?

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- **The Universal Declaration is a standard, but it is not law. However, several covenants, which include the main points of the Declaration, were signed in the 1960s and came into force in 1976 after most of the countries had ratified them. These countries are obliged to abide by them. They also gave the right to the UN to monitor whether or not Governments are observing their citizens' Human Rights.**

**When was the Human Rights Declaration
adopted?.**

On December 10, 1948 by the UN General Assembly. December 10 is observed as Human Rights Day around the world

What is UNDP and its role ?

United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) is the world's largest multilateral source of grant funding for development cooperation. It was created in 1965. Its funds come from the yearly voluntary contributions of Member States of the UN or its affiliated agencies

What is UNEP ?

UN Environment Programme (UNEP) was established as a result of the UN Conference on the Human Environment in Stockholm in 1972.

UNEP's main job is to catalyse environmental action and awareness worldwide. It has its Headquarters in Nairobi, Kenya and is the world's leading environmental agency.

**Why is the World Environment Day
celebrated annually on 5th June?**

**To commemorate the anniversary of the
opening day of the first UN Conference on
the Human Environment in Stockholm in
1972**

What is the UN Democracy Fund (UNDEF)?

Ans. UN Democracy Fund was established in early 2005 to promote democracy throughout the world by providing assistance for projects that consolidates and strengthens democratic governance. However, UNDEF does not promote any sample model of democracy. The fund officially began its work on March 6, 2006

What is the role of UNICEF?.

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- **United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund (UNICEF)** was created by the General Assembly during its first session in 1946 with a mandate for the survival, protection and development of children. As the only UN agency devoted exclusively to the needs of children, UNICEF speaks on their behalf and promotes the implementation of the convention on the child, which became international law in September 1990. UNICEF relies entirely upon voluntary public and government contribution. UNICEF was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 1965

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- Name the seventeen agencies, known as “Specialized Agencies” - a term used in the UN Charter.

- (a) International Labour Organisation (ILO).
- (b) Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO).
- (c) UN Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation (UNESCO).
- (d) World Health Organisation (WHO).
- (e) World Bank; International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD). (f) International Development Association (IDA)

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- (g) International Finance Corporation (IFC).
 - (h) Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA).
 - (i) International Monetary Fund (IMF).
 - (j) International Civil Aviation Organisation (ICAO).
 - (k) Universal Postal Union (UPU).

(l) International Telecommunication Union (ITU).

(m) World Meteorological Organisation (WMO).

(n) International Maritime Organisation (IMO)

(o) World Intellectual Property Organisation (WIPO)

(p) International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)

(q) United Nations Industrial Development Organisation (UNIDO)

- The International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) and the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT) do not have the formal status of a specialised agency.

What is the World Bank?

- The World Bank is a group of four institutions;
- The International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD), established in 1945, the International Finance Corporation (IFC), established in 1956, the International Development Association (IDA), established in 1960, and the Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA), established in 1988.
- The Common objective of all four institutions is to help raise standards of living in developing countries by channeling financial resources to those countries from developed countries.

What was the Bretton Woods Conference?

Ans. It was a United Nations Monetary and Financial Conference of 44 Governments held in 1944 at Bretton Woods, USA. It led to the establishment of IBRD - the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development.

What is IMF?

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- **The International Monetary Fund (IMF) founded in December 1945 is an intergovernmental organization to : (a) promote cooperation on international monetary issues; (b) to promote exchange stability; (c) to facilitate balanced growth of international trade; and (d) to make the general resources of the fund temporarily available to members to permit them to correct maladjustments in their balance of payments.**

Was India among the original 51 Member
States of the UN in 1945 ?

Yes

What is IAEA? Give its date of establishment, the place of its Headquarters and its basic objectives.

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- **International Atomic Energy Agency** was established on July 29, 1957 in Vienna. Its two main objectives are to seek to accelerate and enlarge the contribution of atomic energy to peace, health and prosperity throughout the world and to ensure that it is not used in such a way as to further any military purpose. It is administered by a 35- member **Board of Governors** headed by a **Director General**.

**Name the first specialised agency of the
United Nations?.**

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- **ILO - International Labour Organisation.** It was established in 1919 as an autonomous institution associated with the League of Nations. By an agreement approved on December 14, 1946, ILO became the first specialised agency associated with UN. Based at Geneva in Switzerland ILO works to promote social justice for working people everywhere. In ILO, workers, employers and Governments representatives have an equal voice in formulating its policies

“Since war begins in the minds of men, it is in the minds of men that the defences of peace must be constructed.” Where does this well-known quotation come from.

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- From the constitution of **UNESCO - United Nations Educational Scientific and Cultural Organization** - which came into being on November 4, 1946, with Headquarters in Paris, France. UNESCO is involved in promoting education worldwide, preserving the world's heritage and culture, improving accessibility to communication and supporting social scientific research.

**What and when was the first resolution
adopted by the UN General Assembly.**

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- On January 24, 1946, UNGA adopts its first resolution and its main focus was peaceful uses of atomic energy and the elimination of atomic and other weapons of mass destruction.

What is “An Agenda for Development” ?

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- It is a blueprint for improving the human condition. In response to the request of the General Assembly, the Secretary-General issued this report on May 6, 1994.

**Name the forerunner organization of the
UN and the year of its establishment?**

**League of Nations, established in 1919
under the Treaty of Versailles.**

**Which day of the year is celebrated as
International Day of Peace?**

**The General Assembly has designated 21
September as the International Day of
Peace.**

What are the Millennium Development Goals adopted at the Millennium Summit in 2000.

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- (a) Eradicate extreme poverty and hunger (b) Achieve universal primary education (c) Promote gender equality and empower women (d) Reduce child mortality (e) Improve maternal health (f) Combat HIV / AIDS, malaria and other diseases. (g) Ensure environmental sustainability (h) Develop a global partnership for development.

**Why was the Trusteeship Council set-up
and why has it suspended its operations?**

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- Trusteeship Council was set up by the UN to supervise the administration of Trust Territories and its major goal was to promote self-government or independence. On 1 November 1994 the Council has suspended its operation with the independence of Palau, the last remaining UN Trust territory. It will now meet as occasions required at the request of General Assembly or the Security Council

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- **Who are the Messengers of Peace and Goodwill Ambassadors. Who appoints them.**

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- They are prominent personalities who have lent their names, talents and time to support UN programmes. Messengers of Peace are appointed by the UN Secretary-General. The Goodwill Ambassadors are appointed by a cross-section of funds. Indian tennis player Vijay Amritraj was appointed UN Messenger of Peace on February 2001

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- **What is NPT? Has India signed it, if not why?**

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- **The Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons (NPT)**, the most universal of all multilateral disarmament treaties, was first opened for signature in 1968 and came into force in 1970. The NPT is the cornerstone of the global nuclear nonproliferation regime and the essential foundation for the pursuit of nuclear disarmament. India is not a signatory to NPT because India considers it a discriminatory treaty.

**Name the Indian who contested for the
post of UN Secretary - General?**

Mr. Shashi Tharoor of India
